

INTERNATIONAL news

Intel to beef up its investment in Europe for making chips

US chipmaker Intel has revealed that it will invest up to 80 billion euros (\$88 billion) across Europe in the next decade, as part of which it plans to build a semiconductor plant in Germany. The chipmaker will allot 17 billion euros to beef up its European production capacity with a semiconductor fab mega-site in Magdeburg, Germany. The site will include two semiconductor factories, or fabs, that will make chips with Intel's advanced technology.

Nvidia interested in using Intel for manufacturing its chips

Following the fallout of its deal to acquire British chip firm ARM Ltd, Nvidia has shown interest in partnering with US chipmaker Intel to make chips. Early last year, Intel decided to expand its business into making chips that others design as well, called the foundry business, and has announced several multibillion-dollar projects for new manufacturing centres in the United States and Europe.

SK Hynix looking to acquire Arm through a consortium

Months after the fallout of the highly-anticipated Nvidia-Arm deal, South Korean chipmaker SK Hynix is looking to form a consortium to acquire British semiconductor company Arm. "We are reviewing possibly forming a consortium, together with strategic partners, to jointly acquire it," Park Jung-ho, Vice Chairman and CEO of SK Hynix, told reporters after the company's annual shareholders meeting. The idea of possible acquisition is, however, at an early stage.

Kioxia and Western Digital to build new flash memory fab

Kioxia Holdings Corp is looking to collaborate with Western Digital Corp to build a new flash memory fab together. The facility is set to be built at the latter's plant in northern Japan, which may reportedly entail an investment of around \$8.3 billion.

Samsung and Western Digital to develop next-gen storage

Samsung Electronics has signed an MoU with Western Digital to co-develop next-generation data placement, processing, and fabrics (D2PF) storage technologies. The companies will initially focus on aligning their efforts and creating a vigorous ecosystem

for zoned storage solutions, including zoned name spaces SSDs and shingled magnetic recording HDDs.

SEMIKRON and Danfoss Silicon Power merge to specialise

SEMIKRON and Danfoss Silicon Power announced a merger to create a joint business specialised in power electronics focusing on power semiconductor modules. The newly formed SEMIKRON-Danfoss joint business will be owned by the current owner-families of SEMIKRON and the Danfoss Group, with Danfoss being the majority owner. The new joint business will be managed by one common leadership team, retaining existing production facilities, customer and supplier relationships, and distribution channels.

US chip firm Ampere Computing files for IPO

American server processor startup Ampere Computing has filed for an IPO in the United States. A public listing would give Ampere an infusion of cash and potential access to more investment further down the line via public markets. Oracle has quietly invested \$426 million in Ampere, which is run by former Intel president Renée James.

Wacom, STMicroelectronics and CEVA collaborate for digital pens

CEVA, together with STMicroelectronics and Wacom, have announced their collaboration to develop an enhanced digital pen experience with a new, wireless sensor module that extends the digital pen's functionality through advanced gesture, cursor, and motion control. The combined effort leverages the specialised capabilities of the three companies to create an advanced, sensor-enabled digital pen that can be adopted by OEMs to add value to their smartphone, tablet, notebook, PC, interactive whiteboard, or other smart-display products.

Analog Devices and Gridspertise join forces for smart grids

Analog Devices and Gridspertise are collaborating to advance the resiliency and quality of smart grids around the world. The collaboration enables the development of new hardware and software that support distribution grid self-healing and adaptation in response to the significant changes in energy supply and demand as renewable energy sources are brought online.

ment (FDI) location for electronics research and development, as per an assessment conducted using investment location comparison tool called fDi Benchmark. Chennai emerged as the cheapest location in the top hundred electronics FDI destinations, with estimated annual operating costs of \$1.24 million for a fifty-person R&D centre. Among the world's competitive locations, Chennai was ranked second, only after Seoul, which is home for large campuses of players like Samsung and LG Electronics.

Niti Aayog to roll out battery swapping policy

Keeping in line with the Finance Minister's promise in the Union Budget speech, NITI Aayog is likely to roll out a battery swapping policy by December this year. "The Battery Swapping Policy is likely to be rolled out by December," Sudhendu Jyoti Sinha, adviser (Infrastructure-Transport and Electric Mobility), NITI Aayog, informed. Sinha also said that the Aayog is working on a proposal to prod railways to set up electric vehicle

charging stations at railway stations in cities whose population is more than one million.

Government begins probe as more e-bikes catch fire

Following recurring incidents of electric bikes catching fire, Road Transport and Highways Secretary Giridhar Aramane told media that independent experts in science and technology space will probe the incidents and submit a report. The government has ordered a probe into the matter.